I completed sixty years of age on 15 October 1991. I had decided to devote my retirement to fulfil ing what I saw as my duties in the
sphere of social service. Instead, two things happened simultaneously. First, I agreed to continue in government service for another three years and, next, a young col eague, Arun Tiwari, requested me to share my reminiscences with him, so that he could record them. He was someone who had been working in my laboratory since 1982, but I had never real y known him wel until the February of 1987 when I visited him at the Intensive Coronary Care Unit of the Nizam's Institute of Medical Sciences in Hyderabad. He was a mere 32 years old, but was fighting valiantly for his life. I asked him if there was anything he wanted me to do for him. "Give me your blessings, sir," he said, "so that I may have a longer life and can complete at least one of your projects."
The young man's dedication moved me and I prayed for his recovery al night. The Lord answered my prayers and Tiwari was able to get back to work in a month. He did an excel ent job in helping to realise the Akash missile airframe from scratch within the short space of three years.